

In fact, while I was writing this book, Joseph and I experienced one of the most trying years of our marriage. We had our first job loss, months of vacancy on the house we rent out in Upstate NY, and an expensive hospital bill that took us months to pay off. I say all that not for you to feel bad for us, but because it forced us to look at our budget, cut out a lot of unnecessary items, and really put into practice everything I talk about in the coming pages.

While a hard financial situation can feel paralyzing at the moment, now's the time when it's most crucial to act. You have to form a plan. For us, we methodically went through all of our expenses, one by one, to see what would make the biggest difference. We trimmed a lot of fat, found a few leaks, and lowered bills that we previously thought would barely make a dent. Because of this experience, I truly believe *every* expense always deserves a second look!

Think about this—how would your life change if:

- You shaved an extra \$75 a month off your grocery bill?
- You found an extra \$40 a month by switching phone carriers?
- You whittled down your car insurance by \$25 a month with one simple phone call?

This is the potential *31 Days to Radically Reduce Your Expenses* has in store for you. And this time, you don't have to do it alone. Over the next 31 days, we'll walk through every single part of your budget together, take a hard look at what you're currently spending, and explore the tools and resources to change them for the better...even if you already think they're as low as they can go!

HOW TO READ THIS BOOK

Although the title suggests that you complete a chapter a day, one of the best parts about this book is that there's no requirement on how much time you spend on each section! You can read it from start to finish, or jump